to have been achieved to a significant extent? Again, I leave it to the reader to draw their own conclusions while I place first-hand material before them.

By July 1823, the Governor-General in Council had passed a resolution for the creation of a Committee for Public Instruction ‘with a view to the better instruction of the people, to the introduction among them of useful knowledge and to the improvement of their moral character’.[33] In that very same month, Holt Mackenzie, a British colonial administrator, wrote a note on the government’s scheme to pursue public education, wherein he stressed the need for a Christian scheme of education for the native elites in order to influence the ‘lower orders’, evidenced by the following extract[34]:

> The education indeed of the great body of the people can never, I think, be expected to extend beyond what is necessary for the business of life; and it is only therefore through religious exercises, which form a great part of the business of life, that the labourer will turn his thoughts on things above the common drudgery, by which he earns his subsistence. *Hence it is under the Christian scheme alone, that I should expect to find the labouring classes really educated: and their station in the scale of instructed and humanized beings will, I imagine, be pretty closely proportioned to their piety. We have no such instrument, with which to work beneficially on the lower orders here. Further the natural course of things in all countries seems to be that knowledge introduced from abroad should descend from the higher or educated classes and gradually spread through their example. We surely cannot here, at least expect the servant to prize a learning, which his master despises or hates. The influence of Europeans, if they use not the influential classes of the native community, must necessarily be very confined. What is taught in our schools will only be thought of there.* Our scholars, if of the common people when they enter the world, will find no sympathy among their fellows, and until the lessons of the master, or professor become the subject of habitual thought and conversation, they cannot touch the heart, they will little affect the understanding. The acquirement will be an act of memory, with little more of feeling or reflection than if nonsense verses were the theme [emphasis added].